

# Seawall height in Lake Worth Beach

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

LAKE WORTH BEACH • PALM BEACH COUNTY

## No minimum set in local code

Lake Worth Beach sets no seawall height. Its waterways chapter only fixes the bulkhead line and fill limits.

### The detail

|                |                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MINIMUM        | None set                                                                                                                                                                     |
| BULKHEAD LINE  | Lake Worth bulkhead line, landfill and dredging limits - Ch. 22 Sec. 22-1                                                                                                    |
| FENCES         | No solid opaque fencing within 15 ft of bulkhead - Sec. 23.4-4                                                                                                               |
| FLOODPLAIN     | Seawalls listed as other development, no elevation - Sec. 23.7-17                                                                                                            |
| LINE LANDMARKS | The line passes a Corps of Engineers brass disk (IWP No. 11, 1956) at the mainland end of the Lake Worth Bridge; a second segment ends at the Casino property - Sec. 22-1(a) |
| FILL           | Since 13 Aug 1959 no fill on the channel side, and landward filling or dredging needs formal written approval - Sec. 22-1(b)                                                 |
| EXTENDING LAND | City commission application with plans and the dredge source, subject to state trustees and Army Corps approval; permits last two years - Sec. 22-1(c)-(d)                   |

**Where this comes from:** City of Lake Worth Beach Code, Ch. 22 Waterways, Sec. 22-1

**Verified:** 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

### Before you call a contractor

#### 1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2

**Get the existing elevation surveyed**

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3

**Ask what triggers the requirement**

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4

**Ask about building higher now**

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.